

Article Verification Prompt (Stackmode QA Checklist)

Use this before publishing any AI assisted article. Run the piece through all 6 layers in order. Do not skip layers. Do not publish anything that fails and has not been fixed.

Layer 1: Plagiarism Check

Question: Is it original?

Every AI generated piece must be checked. AI sometimes reproduces training data verbatim.

Tools to run it through:

- Copyscape (industry standard)
- Turnitin (academic grade)
- Grammarly (built in plagiarism check)
- CopyLeaks (AI generated detection)

Red flag: more than 5% similarity to any single source.

Action if flagged: rewrite or reject the section.

Layer 2: Factual Verification

Question: Are the claims true?

Check every factual claim in the piece. For each one ask:

- Is it verifiable?
- Can I find a credible source for it?
- Is the interpretation correct?
- Is it current (this year's data, not outdated data)?

Method: spot check 10 random claims per piece.

If more than 2 fail: rewrite the entire piece.

Layer 3: Source Validation

Question: Are the citations real?

AI cites sources. Confirm they actually exist and say what the AI claims they say.

Red flags:

- URL does not exist (403, 404 errors)
- Citation format is wrong or misquoted
- The study does not say what the AI claims (misrepresented)
- Source is not authoritative (weak citation)

Method: click every citation. Verify accuracy.

Time cost: 15 to 30 minutes per piece. Worth it, this is what prevents credibility damage.

Layer 4: Data Accuracy

Question: Are the numbers correct?

Numbers are the most checked claims readers and AI engines both scrutinize. Verify:

- Is the statistic correct, within margin of error?
- Is the source recent enough?
- Is context preserved, not misleading when pulled out of context?
- Is the source authoritative?

Example workflow: AI states a stat. Find the original study. Confirm the number matches. Check if the study year is still current enough to cite. If yes, approve but cite the year directly in the article so readers and AI engines see it is dated correctly.

Layer 5: Tone and Voice Check

Question: Does it match brand?

AI can match tone on the surface but miss nuance. Check:

- Does it match brand voice? Formal, casual, or technical, whichever Stackmode is going for in that piece.
- Are there jarring transitions between sections?
- Is the confidence level appropriate? Confident on certainties, cautious when it is actually an opinion.
- Is it condescending or overly simplified for the audience?

If the piece sounds too generic or too "marketingy" when it should sound educational, rewrite those sections to match voice. No dashes, no AI spacing, no generic filler phrases, per Stackmode's standing style rules.

Layer 6: Final Human Review

Question: Would I trust this?

After the first 5 layers, read the full piece and ask:

- Would I trust this content?
- Does it sound AI written when it is not supposed to?
- Are there any red flags I missed in the earlier layers?
- Would I recommend this to a peer or a client?

Trust your gut. If something feels off, it probably is. Do not publish until this feels clean.

Automation Notes

What can be automated:

- Plagiarism check (Copyscape API)
- Basic factual checks (search the claim, verify against a source)
- Tone analysis (Grammarly API)
- Readability (Hemingway Editor API)

What must stay manual, never automate:

- Source validation
- Context verification
- Final approval

Automation saves roughly 30% of QA time. Humans still have to do the critical judgment calls, especially source validation and the final call to publish.

Extra Layer: Getting Cited by AI Engines (Copilot, ChatGPT, etc)

This applies once the piece is verified and ready to actually rank or get cited.

Put a direct answer, price, source, and honest limit on every page. AI tools need a sentence they can quote without needing the rest of the article.

- If the article answers "best X," name the specific products and say who each one is best for.
- If the article is "X vs Y," compare both using the exact same criteria and format.
- If the article is about price, show the current price and explain what changes it.

Every page should include:

- A direct answer near the top.
- A clear "best for" line for each option covered.
- One comparison table using consistent columns.
- Links to original sources.
- The prices and features actually checked.
- One honest limit per option covered.
- Any quoted sentence should be able to stand alone if quoted by an AI engine.

Check where competitors are already being cited and get positioned there instead of just posting more content on your own site. Publishing another post on your own site will not place you inside a competitor's existing listicle placement. Instead, find where your competitors are already being mentioned:

- Best tools lists
- Competitor alternative pages
- Independent comparisons
- Review directories
- Reddit, Quora, and other community answers

Prioritize pages that already name three or more competitors but leave Stackmode out. Never reach out asking to simply be added. Instead, pitch what the page is missing (a category, a comparison point, an audience) so inclusion is earned, not requested.

Quick Pre-Publish Gate

Do not publish until every box below is true:

- ☐ Passed plagiarism check, under 5% similarity to any single source
- ☐ 10 spot checked claims, 2 or fewer failures
- ☐ Every citation clicked and confirmed accurate
- ☐ Every number verified against its source and year noted
- ☐ Voice matches brand, no dashes, no AI spacing, no generic filler
- ☐ Passed the gut check on final read
- ☐ Has a direct answer, comparison table, and honest limits if it is a comparison or "best of" style piece